ProjectKit

Tell us what you're building. We'll figure out everything you need.

PROJECT PACK

August 19, 2026

Concrete — 20 × 16 ft

Outdoor & Structural · Challenging · A full weekend with help

YOU NEED APPROXIMATELY

4.35 yd³

Recommended purchase: 4.50 yd³ including 10% waste

Project summary

Project area	**320 sq ft**
Slab thickness	**4 in**
Calculated volume	**3.95 yd³**
Waste allowance	**10%**
Recommended purchase	**4.50 yd³**

Materials & budget

ITEM	QUANTITY	UNIT PRICE	COST
Ready-mix concrete (delivered) Order quantity rounded up to the nearest supplier increment.	4.50 yd³	$165 per yd³	$743
Compactable base gravel Includes 10% compaction allowance.	4.50 yd³	$55.00 per yd³	$248
Welded wire mesh ESTIMATE Coverage allowance including overlap. Reinforcement needs vary by use and local practice.	336 sq ft	—	—
Form boards (2×4 or 2×6) ESTIMATE Perimeter plus 10% for corners and overlap.	79 linear ft	—	—
Form stakes ESTIMATE Roughly one every 3 ft, plus corners.	28 stakes	—	—
Estimated material total			**$990**

Costs use ProjectKit planning prices or the prices entered by the project owner. They are not live retail prices.

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Options compared

Ready-mix delivery

One truck, one pour. Best once you pass about a cubic yard.

Order quantity	**4.50 yd³**
Estimated concrete cost	**$743**

Bagged concrete

No delivery minimum, but mixing is the whole afternoon.

Bags needed	**261 bags**
Estimated concrete cost	**$1,697**

Shopping list

- [ ] Ready-mix concrete (delivered)
  4.50 yd³
- [ ] Compactable base gravel
  4.50 yd³
- [ ] Welded wire mesh
  336 sq ft
- [ ] Form boards (2×4 or 2×6)
  79 linear ft
- [ ] Form stakes
  28 stakes
- [ ] Screed board (straight 2×4 longer than the slab width)
- [ ] Expansion joint material where the slab meets existing concrete
- [ ] Bull float or magnesium float
- [ ] Concrete edger and groover
- [ ] Curing compound or plastic sheeting
- [ ] Waterproof gloves, eye protection, knee pads
- [ ] Rebar chairs or mesh supports

Project sequence

1. Mark out the slab and check it for square by measuring both diagonals.
2. Call for utility locates before you dig.
3. Excavate to slab thickness plus base depth.
4. Add and compact the gravel base in layers.
5. Build and brace the forms, setting the slope for drainage.

6. Place reinforcement on chairs so it sits mid-slab.
7. Re-check dimensions, depth, and slope before the concrete arrives.
8. Place the concrete and screed it level with the forms.
9. Float, edge, and finish once the bleed water is gone.
10. Cure it — keep it damp or covered for several days.
11. Strip the forms and backfill the edges.

Assumptions used

Waste allowance	**10%**
Concrete price	**$165 per yd³**
Bag yield	**0.45 cu ft per bag**
Reinforcement	**Welded wire mesh**
Base course	**4 in compacted gravel**

How it was calculated

Area Exact	**Length × Width**
Volume Exact	**Area × (Thickness ÷ 12)**
Cubic yards Exact	**Cubic feet ÷ 27**
Waste adjusted Exact	**Calculated quantity × (1 + Waste percentage)**
Order rounding Assumption	**Rounded up to the next 0.25 yd³**
Base gravel Assumption	**Area × (Base depth ÷ 12) × 1.10 compaction allowance**

Before you start

Concrete sets on its own schedule. Have every tool, helper, and form check done before the truck arrives.

Slab thickness, reinforcement, and base depth requirements vary by use and by local code. Verify before you pour.

Slab thickness, reinforcement, base depth, and footing requirements vary by use, soil, climate, and local building code. Verify structural and code requirements before you build.

Notes